

EDMOND HALLEY

1656-1742

DATA FILE



KEY ACHIEVEMENT: Proved that a particular comet would return



COUNTRY OF ORIGIN: UK



YEAR OF DISCOVERY: 1705

Halley invented the diving bell, in which he plunged 18.3 m (60 ft) below the River Thames.

Edmond Halley devoted only a portion of his time to astronomy. He was also a mathematics professor, a sea captain, and a spy. But his name is forever linked to the comet named after him. After studying its orbit around the Sun, he predicted that it would return in 1758, 53 years later. It did and every 75 to 76 years since.



Halley's Comet